



Chapter 1

Parts of Speech - Pronouns & Verbs

6th Grade Grammar

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Lesson 1.4

Pronouns

Personal Pronouns

-  **Pronoun** is a word that takes the place of one or more nouns or pronouns
 - The myth amuses Kim. **It** amuses **her**.
 - Raymond and Carl offered the dog a treat. **They** offered **it** a treat.
- **Personal pronouns** are used most often and show *number* and *person*.
 - *Number* tells whether the pronoun is singular or plural.
 - *Person* shows the relationship between speaker and the pronoun.

Personal Pronouns



First Person
(the speaker)

Singular

I, me

Plural

we, us

Second
Person
(the person
addressed)

you

you

Third Person
(person or
thing being
discussed)

he, him
she, her
it

they, them

Possessive Pronouns

-  **Possessive pronouns** shows ownership and replaces a possessive noun.
 - Mom's pie is delicious. **Her** pie is delicious.
 - Are the girls' answers correct? Are **their** answers correct?

Possessive Pronouns



Singular

Plural

First Person
(the speaker)

my, mine

our, ours

Second
Person
(the person
addressed)

your, yours

your, yours

Third Person
(person or
thing being
discussed)

his, her, hers, its

their, theirs

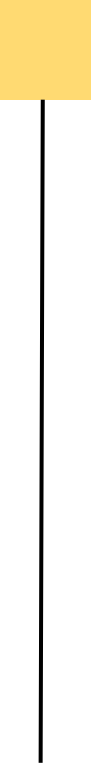
Possessive Pronouns

	Singular	Plural
Used Before Nouns	My Your His / Her/ Its	Our Your Their
Used Alone	Mine Yours His / Hers / Its	Ours Yours Theirs

Pronouns and Antecedents

-  **Antecedent** is the word or words to which a pronoun refers.
 - Jerry lost his hat.
 - *Jerry* is the antecedent. *His* is the pronoun.
 - Beth and I bought food with our money.
 - *Beth* and *I* are the antecedents. *Our* is the pronoun.





Lesson 1.5

Reflexive Pronouns



Reflexive & Intensive Pronouns

-  **Reflexive pronouns** refer back to the subject (the antecedent) used earlier in the same sentence
- Reflexive pronouns end with -self or -selves and can be singular or plural



I helped **myself** since no one was home.

- *I* is the antecedent (subject)

It protected **itself**.

- *It* is the antecedent (subject)

We fed **ourselves** for dinner.

- *We* is the antecedent (subject)

You defend **yourselves**.

- *You* is the antecedent (subject)



Reflexive Pronouns

Singular

myself

yourself

himself/ herself/ itself

Plural

ourselves

yourselves

themselves



Hisself vs. Himself

- Hisself is not a reflexive pronoun
- It is an incorrect form of *himself*

✗ He moved hissself into position.

✓ He moved **himself** into position.

Theirselves vs. Themselves

- Theirselves is not a reflexive pronoun
- It is an incorrect form of *themselves*

✗ They built theirselves a garage.

✓ They built **themselves** a garage.



Lesson 1.6

Demonstrative Pronouns



Demonstrative Pronouns

-  **Demonstrative pronouns** point out specific people, places, or things.

 Demonstrative Pronouns	
Singular	Plural
This That	These Those

 **This** and **these** are used to refer to something that is **physically close** to the speaker.

Physically close

- **This** is your sister. (singular)
- **These** are your gloves. (plural)

 **That** and **those** are used to refer to something that is at a **physical distance** from the speaker.

Physical distance

- **That** is a large dog. (singular)
- **Those** are wild geese. (plural)

In these examples, the **demonstrative pronouns** are in bold. The nouns to which they refer are underlined.



Them is not a **demonstrative pronoun**.

✗ *Them* are my parents.

✓ **Those** are my parents.

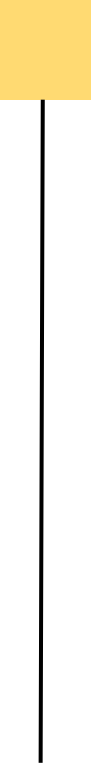
Here or **there** should **never** be used with a demonstrative pronoun.

✗ This *here* is an expensive guitar.

✓ **This** is an expensive guitar.

✗ That *there* is a hornet!

✓ **That** is a hornet!



Lesson 1.7

Indefinite Pronouns



Indefinite Pronouns

-  **Indefinite pronouns** refer to one or more unspecified people, places, or things
 - Does **anyone** know the story of Midas?
 - **Each** was out of place.
 - **Neither** was selected.
 - **Anybody** can play the game.



Some Indefinite Pronouns

Singular

another	everybody	no one
anybody	everyone	nothing
anyone	everything	one
anything	much	somebody
each	neither	someone
either	nobody	something

Plural

both
few
many
others
several



Lesson 1.8

Interrogative Pronouns



Interrogative Pronouns

-  An **interrogative pronoun** introduces a **question**.
 - **Who** is Pandora?
 - For **whom** does Hephaestus make a staff?
 - **What** is Pandora's curiosity about?
-  When the words **who**, **whom**, **whose**, **what**, and **which** are used to ask a **question**, they are called **interrogative pronouns**.

Who vs. Whom

Interrogative pronouns *who* and *whom* both refer to people.

-  *Who* refers to people
 - ***Who*** knocked at the door?
 - ***Who*** wants breakfast?

 -  *Whom* also refers to people. *Whom* is often used after prepositions such as to, for, and with
 - To ***whom*** are you speaking?
 - For ***whom*** did you vote?
-

Who vs. Whom

- It is easy to be confused about when to use **who** or **whom**. When this occurs, substitute **he** and **him** into the sentence. If **he** sounds correct, then use **who**. If **him** sounds correct, then use **whom**.
- (**Who** or **whom**) went to the park?
 - **He** went to the park  **who** is correct
 - **Him** went to the park  **whom** is incorrect
- You ate lunch with (**who** or **whom**)?
 - You ate lunch with **he**  **who** is incorrect
 - You ate lunch with **him**  **whom** is correct

Who vs. Whom

Sometimes it is necessary to rearrange the sentence.

- (Who or Whom) have you invited?
 - Have you invited she? ☐ who is incorrect
 - Have you invited her? ☒ whom is correct
- To (who or whom) did you speak?
 - Did you speak to he? ☐ who is incorrect
 - Did you speak to him? ☒ whom is correct

Whose vs. What. vs Which

-  Use whose to refer to people or things.
 - **Whose** do you prefer?
 - **Whose** did you borrow?
 -  Use what to refer to things or animals.
 - **What** do you want for dinner?
 - **What** is the name of your dog?
 -  Use which to refer to people or things.
 - **Which** did you buy?
 - **Which** will win?
-

Whose vs. Who's

- *Whose* shows that someone possesses something.
 - The jar is in Pandora's house. **Whose** is it?
- Do not confuse *whose* with *who's*
 - **Who's** reading the myth? [contraction of who is]
 - **Whose** is it? [interrogative pronoun showing possession]

Practice!

Circle the correct interrogative pronoun in parentheses to complete the sentence.

1. To (who, whose, whom) should I address this letter? [object of preposition]
2. (Who, Whose, Whom) weapons were the greatest in all of Greece? [shows possession]
3. (Who, Whose, Whom) lead the Trojans into battle with the greatest degree of confidence?
[subject]
4. (Who, Whom, Whose) does Paris declare the most beautiful goddess? [direct object]
5. (Who, Whose, Whom) did Cupid shoot with a lead and golden arrow? [direct object]
6. Who, Whose, Whom) arrows were they? [shows possession]



Lesson 1.9

Action Verbs and Linking Verbs



Action Verb

-  An action verb tells of or shows an action.
 - Physical actions are something you can typically “see.”
 - Mental actions are actions that take place but cannot be easily seen.

Physical

- Run
- Jump
- Play

Mental

- Believe
- Forget
- Know



Practice!

Complete the sentence with a verb. Say if the verb is physical or mental.

1. George _____ loudly.
 2. Mom _____ a lot.
 3. We _____ pasta.
 4. I _____ the answer.
 5. He _____ poetry?
 6. Please _____ down.
 7. Shelby _____ fast.
 8. You _____ about it.
- 

Linking Verb

-  A **linking verb** expresses the condition or state of being and serve as a link between words.
- The most commonly used **linking verbs** are forms of the verb **be**, which are **am, is, are, was, and were**.

Examples:

- I **am** hungry
- He **is** tall
- We **are** tired.

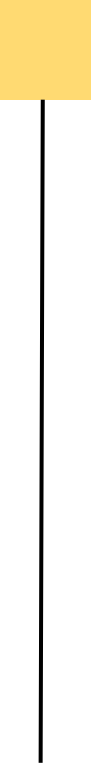
Notice how each **verb** in bold is a **link** between the words on either side of it.



Practice!

Complete the sentence with a linking verb.

1. I _____ hungry.
 2. He _____ tall.
 3. We _____ tired.
 4. The food _____ delicious.
 5. My shoes _____ tight.
 6. I _____ late.
 7. The door _____ closed.
 8. The clouds _____ dark.
- 



Lesson

1.10

Other Linking Verbs

Other Linking Verbs

-  A **linking verb** expresses the condition or state of being and serve as a link between words.
- Other common linking verbs are words such as **appear, seem, look, smell, taste, feel, sound**, and their various forms.

Examples:

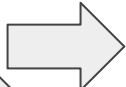
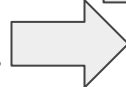
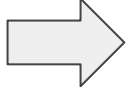
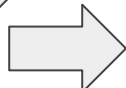
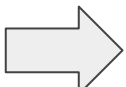
- I **feel** ill.
- The patient **seems** alert.
- Our soup **tastes** bland.

Again notice how each **verb** in bold is a **link** between the words on either side of it.

Other Linking Verbs continued

-  If you replace these other linking verbs with a form of the verb **be** (**am**, **is**, **are**, **was**, and **were**) the sentence will still make sense.

Examples:

- The birds **appear** calm.  The birds **are** calm.
- You **seemed** tired.  You **were** tired.
- That team **looks** good.  That team **is** good.
- The food **smelled** delicious!  The food **was** delicious.
- This **tastes** odd.  This **is** odd.

Action Verb and Linking Verbs

- Many of the **linking verbs** just mentioned can also be used as **action verbs**.

Linking Verbs

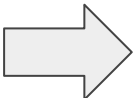
- The clothes smell clean.
- This path looks safe.
- Our soup tastes bland.
- The water feels warm.

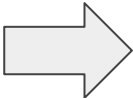
Action Verbs

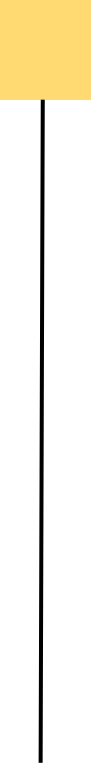
- I smell clean clothes.
- Did you look at the path?
- Matt tasted the soup.
- Did you feel the water?

Action Verb vs Linking Verbs

- To decide if the word is a **linking verb** or an **action verb**, simply replace it with a form of the verb be. If the sentence makes sense, then it is a linking verb. If it does not make sense, then it is an action verb.

The clothes **smell** clean.  The clothes **are** clean.  Linking verb

I **smell** clean clothes.  I **am** clean clothes.  Action verb



Lesson

1.11

Main Verbs and Helping Verbs



Main Verbs

 A **main verb** expresses the **action** or **being** in the sentence. It tells what the subject **does** or **is**.

- Action
 - Joe jumps the fence
- Being
 - Joe is tired.

In these examples, the verb **jumps** tell what Joe **does** and the verb **is** tells what Joe **is**.

Helping Verbs

 A **helping verb** works with the **main verb** to **help** it express its meaning.

- Action
 - Joe will jump the fence
- Being
 - Joe should be tired.

In these examples, the verbs **will** and **should** are **helping verbs** to the main verbs **jump** and **be**. They help express the meaning of the main verbs.

Helping Verb Examples

am is are was were be being been	have has had	do does did	shall will should would	may might must can could
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Verb Phrases

 A **verb phrase** contains a **main verb** preceded by one or more **helping verbs**.

Examples:

- I **was** reading an exciting book!
- She **has been** practicing for two hours.
- Diego **must have been** writing his letter.

In these examples, the **bolded words** are **helping verbs**. The underlined words are main verbs. The **bold word** with the underlined word are the **verb phrases**.



Lesson

1.12

Interrupted Verb Phrases



Interrupted Verb Phrases

- ✎ Sometimes a **verb phrase** is interrupted by other words.
- ✎ **Questions** should be changed to **statements** to find the **verb phrase**.

Has Charles left for the store?



Charles **has** left for the store.

Changing the **question** into a **statement** makes the **verb phrase** easier to find. In this example, the **verb phrase** is **has left**.

More examples:

Will you pass the salt?



You **will** pass the salt.

Did Marcia lose her gloves?



Marcia **did** lose her gloves.





Words such as **not** (and its **contraction** form **n't**), **never**, **hardly**, **surely**, and **always** are often found in the middle of a **verb phrase**, but they are **not** verbs and are **never** a part of the verb phrase.

- She has **not** eaten her lunch.
- Marcus will **always** help his mother.

In these examples, the **verb phrases** are **has eaten** and **will help**. The words **not** and **always** are **not** part of the verb phrases mentioned.

More examples:

- I have **never** heard that song.
(The verb phrase is have heard.)
- Stacy didn't know the answer.
(The verb phrase is did know.)
- The reporter will **surely** tell the truth.
(The verb phrase is will tell.)